

New-Hire Readiness Operating Playbook

Target attainment, learning confidence, sigma exceptions, and forecast response

(All programs, cohorts, agents, and observations are deterministic synthetic data.)

1) KPI Reference and How to Interpret Shifts

Use this playbook after the governed metrics identify a material readiness gap. It defines what to verify, how to triage, and which measurable response is appropriate without overstating correlation as causation.

KPIs covered

- `static_target_attainment_rate`: Direction-aware share of new-hire observations meeting the production target.
- `days_to_target`: Modeled tenure day at which the selected curve reaches the static target.
- `best_model_r_squared`: Fit-quality context for deciding whether a learning-curve conclusion is reliable.
- `sigma_boundary_attainment`: Cohort performance relative to direction-aware tenured one, two, and three-sigma boundaries.
- `forecast_interval`: Six-month Prophet outlook with an 80 percent uncertainty interval.

General interpretation rules

- Weight KPI scores with raw numerators and denominators; never average agent percentages.
- Treat AHT, ACW, and Hold Time as lower-is-better; all other published KPIs are higher-is-better.
- Treat R-squared below 0.30 as inconclusive and avoid target-date commitments.
- Pair performance conclusions with volume quartile and distinct-agent context.
- Use forecasts for planning scenarios, not causal claims or guaranteed outcomes.
- Grain context: date column: `performance\_date`.
- Common filters include service_program, cohort_id, cohort_name, kpi.
- Preserve weighted KPI math
- Respect KPI direction
- Gate weak learning curves
- Carry reliability context
- Treat forecasts as scenarios

2) Scenario Playbooks (Symptoms to Likely Causes to Action Plans)

Scenario A - Material target-attainment gap after day 60

Symptoms

- Static target attainment remains below the program median between tenure days 55 and 60.
- The gap appears across multiple volume quartiles rather than only the lowest-volume observations.

Likely causes

- Training content or nesting support may not match the production KPI mix.
- One channel, language, or site may be driving a broader cohort average.

Action plan recommendations

1. Immediate actions (24-48 hours)

- Validate denominator coverage and direction-aware target logic.
- Segment the cohort by site, channel, language, and volume quartile.
- Compare the same KPI with the prior fictional cohort and tenured benchmark.

2. Short-term actions (1-2 weeks)

- Assign targeted coaching to the confirmed driver segment.
- Review training examples for the affected KPI and channel.
- Track daily recovery against both training and static targets.

Measurement targets

- Improve static target attainment without degrading paired quality or customer KPIs.
- Reduce the cohort gap to the one-sigma tenured boundary.

Scenario B - Slow or inconclusive learning curve

Symptoms

- Days to target is late or null.
- The selected model has R-squared below 0.30 or materially disagrees with other candidates.

Likely causes

- The cohort may have insufficient history, high variance, or a structural process change.
- A single curve family may not represent the observed ramp pattern.

Action plan recommendations

1. Immediate actions (24-48 hours)

- Review all four candidate fits and observation coverage.
- Check whether low-volume days or outliers drive model selection.
- Label the conclusion inconclusive when the confidence gate fails.

2. Short-term actions (1-2 weeks)

- Collect additional tenure history before committing to a target date.
- Investigate training or operating changes aligned with curve breaks.

Measurement targets

- Increase reliable observation coverage and model fit before operationalizing days to target.

Scenario C - Direction-aware sigma exception

Symptoms

- A cohort falls outside the one-sigma tenured boundary in the unfavorable direction.
- The exception persists across consecutive periods or reaches the two-sigma boundary.

Likely causes

- Ramp support may be insufficient for the affected KPI.
- A program-specific mix shift may make the tenured comparator less representative.

Action plan recommendations

1. Immediate actions (24-48 hours)

- Confirm KPI direction and the applicable tenured comparison window.
- Check whether the exception is isolated to one cohort or shared across the program.

2. Short-term actions (1-2 weeks)

- Set a cohort-specific recovery threshold and owner.
- Review the benchmark definition if the operating mix changed materially.

Measurement targets

- Return inside the one-sigma boundary while preserving paired KPI guardrails.

Scenario D - Forecasted readiness or staffing risk

Symptoms

- The forecast deteriorates in the unfavorable direction for multiple future periods.
- The 80 percent interval overlaps a planning threshold.

Likely causes

- Recent cohort mix or performance trend may be carrying into the forecast.
- Wide uncertainty may reflect limited or volatile monthly history.

Action plan recommendations

1. Immediate actions (24-48 hours)

- Separate the point forecast from its lower and upper interval.
- Compare forecast direction with current target attainment and cohort mix.

2. Short-term actions (1-2 weeks)

- Build base, downside, and upside staffing scenarios.
- Refresh the forecast after the next complete period and monitor interval width.

Measurement targets

- Maintain a documented staffing response for the downside interval, not only the point estimate.

3) Recommendation Templates (Vector-Friendly Snippets)

These are short, reusable action cards designed for embedding and retrieval.

Action Card: Readiness triage

Trigger: A cohort misses the day-60 target-attainment expectation.

Actions:

- Validate metric grain, direction, and denominator coverage.
- Rank driver segments by impact and reliability.
- Assign one owner, one recovery date, and paired KPI guardrails.

Expected impact: Converts a broad cohort gap into a measurable, evidence-backed intervention.

Action Card: Model confidence gate

Trigger: A stakeholder asks for a target date from an inconclusive curve.

Actions:

- Show R-squared and all four candidate fits.
- State that the evidence is inconclusive below the 0.30 threshold.
- Request more history before committing to a date.

Expected impact: Prevents false precision in workforce planning.

4) Putting It Together: Example "Recommended Plan" Outputs

Example Plan 1 (QA readiness lags while AHT improves)

Observed trend: A fictional cohort improves lower-is-better AHT but remains below QA target after day 60 with a reliable selected curve.

Plan:

- Validate the QA denominator and compare the cohort across volume quartiles.
- Prioritize coaching for the driver segment without setting an AHT-only incentive.
- Monitor QA target attainment, AHT, and CSAT together for two weeks.

Success metrics: QA target attainment and sigma position improve without materially worsening AHT or CSAT.